In Attendance:

Tonya Harvey ✓	Ashley Shaw ✓	Christina Thrower	Carley Osmond ✓
Kristy Chambers ✓	Deb Wideman ✓	Laura Wehrle✓	Nicole Doherty ✓
Stephanie Szusz	Courtney Horne	Ashley Coleman	Abbi Stevenson ✓
Melissa Martin ✓	Sarah Armour	Brad Hughes ✓	April Lehman
Scott Williams	Kristin Diebel✓	Amy Rodwell	Caitlin Winter
Stephanie Straub	Kristi Wagner	Sarah Williams	

Parent Council Meeting Minutes – January 20, 2025

Approval of last Meeting's Minutes motion by Carley, 2nd by Nicole

Welcome – Kristy Chambers

- Movie night was a success, thanks to Stephanie Straub
- Same night as aces dance gave younger kids something to do while older siblings are out

Principal's Report

- Kindness project – has been a unifying and motivating factor in starting the year
    - Will be one of only 3 schools in Canada with Kindness Certification if/when this is obtains
    - Monthly assemblies, first Friday of the month
    - Undercover week – different theme each day for staff and students try to identify the theme (eg. all black day)
- Facilities manager interested in partnering for outdoor education project
    - Identified a space along Grandview ave side of playground
    - Plant a tree at the end of each school year to provide shade
    - Armourstone circle placed in a circular mulched area
        - Cost approximately $10,000
        - Brad to find out from facilities department how much they can contribute to the project so that Parent Council can identify how much is needed from them
        - Will find out if there is an opportunity to partner with a local business to procure items needed for the space
- **Student nutrition program** – received grant from President's Choice Children's Charities of $6,000 to go toward student nutrition programs
    - Current spend is $400-600/month

    - have reimbursed Nutrition for Learning for their expenditures back to September so that they can provide those services to other schools in need
  - We now have enough to offer to purchase food for the Breakfast Club
    - proposed $100/week to supplement what breakfast club offers
    - We are eligible to apply for more funds at March Break if those funds are exhausted at that time

Voting Between Meetings - procedure

- Email to Chair and Vice Chair
  - Chair and Vice Chair will email council to give everyone a chance to voice concerns and opinions or pose questions
  - timeframe will be attached and email sent by chair and vice chair with last call for final thoughts
  - Google doc for keeping track of votes

Treasurer's Report

- When council votes to set aside funds for a certain purpose, those funds are removed from budget
  - If those funds go unused, they become carry-over to be used in future years **for the same purpose**
    - Those funds cannot be added back into the general budget in subsequent years
- suggested that we allow those carry-over funds to be depleted (or reduced) and then look to approve new funds once those "pots" are depleted, and additional funds are required
  - currently have over $4300 in carry-over available for "teacher wish list" items and $700 for field trips
- Will be looking at per line expenditures over the last few years to better understand the need for funds so that funds can be better allocated

Fundraisers

- Fundraising dollars to be used, in part, toward outdoor learning area and Brad will ensure that information regarding the use of the funds will be put out to the school community
- Would like to do a better job of communicating to families how their fundraising dollars are being used and how much money is raised by the various fundraising initiatives
  - Posters explaining how far we are towards various fundraising goals
    - Table at fun fair to show how fundraising dollars will be used
  - Amy Mairs may be able to use the Instagram account to share some of this information

Hot Lunch

- Vendors lined up until the end of the year
- Welcome feedback regarding the various vendors

Volunteer Coordinator – Deb

- More volunteers have signed up for Wednesday pizza days
- Still need more volunteers for Breakfast Club prep days Monday 10-11 @Stienman Church
    - Big bake once a month
- Family Day Monday @ 8:30am 1 volunteer needed

Parent Involvement Committee – Ashley

- WRDSB committee to understand how to increase parent involvement
    - Ashely has submitted an application

Community Players – Kristy

- Received confirmation of a May 9th matinee performance of Matilda
    - Sarah and Ms. Hill are looking into costing
    - Suggested for Grades 3 and up
- Looking at bringing an arts performance/assembly to the school for the younger grades who will not be participating in the TCP trip
    - Looking for suggestions

Pro-Grant – Kristin

- In contact with New Dundee about partnering – also Baden Public and SAB
- "Safe talk" – breaking down barriers regarding mental health and learning to identify signs of possible suicide risk
    - $3400 budget with $200 for refreshments
    - hosted @SAB
    - Date tbd

Planters

- parent council had previously budgeted $200 for the year for planters but those funds can be reallocated as Abbi Stevenson donated the winter planters and offered to do so for the spring as well

Holiday Hampers

- Budgeted $2000 but spent closer to $1200
    - These funds remain in the parent council account and can be immediately reallocated

Future Meeting Dates:

- Feb 25th
- April 8th
- May 13th
- June (zoom) tbd

Motion to adjourn by Ashley, 2nd by Kristin

Next Meeting Date: February 25th, 2025